



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's talk about what to wear to work.



Learning Outcome:

Identify ways of improving aspects of the use of expressions, structures and vocabulary according to the learning outcomes of level Elementary A.

Ask your partner:

- What do you have to wear for your job?
- What are some clothes you can't wear?

Can Do Statements:

- I can talk about what to wear to work.
- I can ask and respond to advice.
- I can ask for targeted clarifications.





Let's Explore!

Peter talks to Vanessa about what is proper* to wear to work.



* When something is "proper", it is correct.

Instructions: Read the dialogue aloud.

- Peter:** It's hard to know what's appropriate to wear at work. I was hoping you can give me some advice.
- Vanessa:** Well, what's the office environment like exactly?
- Peter:** Most people wear conservative clothing.
- Vanessa:** Well, you definitely should not wear flip-flops or open-toed sandals.
- Peter:** What about sneakers?
- Vanessa:** What do you mean by sneakers? Running shoes are not appropriate.
- Peter:** Oh, do you think cargo pants are acceptable?
- Vanessa:** What kind of pants are you referring to?
- Peter:** Straight leg cotton ones with pockets.
- Vanessa:** Nicely ironed cargo pants are fine. T-shirts aren't professional.
- Peter:** Oh, I wouldn't wear a t-shirt. Do you think shirts should always be tucked in?
- Vanessa:** Business shirts should be tucked in, but some shirts look nice untucked.
- Peter:** Well, thanks so much. I need to keep that in mind.





Let's Practice!

What can Peter wear to work?

Instructions: Read the dialogue. Choose the correct answer.

How does Peter ask Vanessa for advice?

- ☐ Could you think for me?
- ☐ Could you give me some advice?
- ☐ Could you advice me?

Peter asks about cargo pants. What does he ask?

- ☐ Are cargo pants acceptable?
- ☐ What are cargo pants?
- ☐ Am I wearing cargo pants?

Peter accepts Vanessa's advice. He says: "I need to ...

- ☐ think about that."
- ☐ tuck it in."
- ☐ keep that in mind."



Let's Practice!

You shouldn't wear that at work.

Instructions: Read the dialogue again. Draw a line from the question or statement on the left to the response on the right.

flip-flops

T-shirt

cargo pants

dress shirts

running shoes

acceptable to wear at work

should be tucked in

not advisable

not professional footwear

should not wear to work





Extension Activity

Comparing dress codes in different environments.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think about different places you can go in your city or hometown. (e.g. *job interview, BBQ party, etc.*)
- Write each event on a card.
- Take turns to pick up a card and read the card to a partner.
- You and your partner give different pieces of advice on what to wear or what not to wear.
- When all the cards are finished, choose the best advice for each situation.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write about different environments.

☐
☐

I talk about what is appropriate to wear in different situations.

☐
☐

I discuss the best piece of advice for each situation.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **appropriate** (adjective): describes what is proper or acceptable to do
e.g. It is not appropriate to open someone's desk drawers when you go into their office.
- **sloppy** (adjective): describes something that's not tidy
e.g. It looks sloppy to not shave and wear an old shirt to work.
- **tucked** (adjective): describes the bottom of your shirt being placed neatly in pants
e.g. When men wear a business shirt, it should always be tucked in.
- **open-toed** (adjective): describes sandals with uncovered toes
e.g. Men should definitely not wear open-toed sandals in an office.
- **sneakers** (noun): running shoes or other sporty shoes
e.g. Sneakers are comfortable but not advisable for work.
- **flip-flops** (noun): rubber sandals that separate the big toe from the second toe
e.g. Flip-flops are great for the beach but not acceptable at work.
- **acceptable** (adjective): describes what is accepted by others
e.g. Ironed straight leg cotton pants are acceptable in an office.
- **conservative** (adjective): dressing modestly, not liking or accepting changes or new ideas
e.g. Most people wear conservative clothing.



Learning Points

Asking for Targeted Clarification

You ask for targeted clarification when you want more details of what the other person is talking about.

We often ask for targeted clarification when we are not clear on what the other person is referring to. We ask the other person to be more specific by giving more information.

Question	Meaning
What do you mean by that?	What are you really trying to say?
Can you be more specific?	Can you give me more details?

Examples

Manager : *Casual shoes shouldn't be worn to the office.*

Employee : *I'm sorry, but can you be more specific?*

Manager : *Flip-flops and sneakers are not permitted.*

Formal vs. Casual Clothes

Some workplaces have certain dress codes - rules about what you can wear at work.

In certain companies, you can wear casual clothing. In some other formal workplaces, you are not allowed to wear certain types of clothing.

Formal	Informal
black or brown dress shoes	sporty shoes, sneakers
dress shirts with collars	T-shirts
suits, dress pants	jeans

We use modals (should and could) when asking and responding to advice.

Examples

- *I got a job with an IT company, and I can wear jeans and sneakers to work.*
- *At the bank, you can't wear a T-shirt and running shoes.*

